

cover which Wäinämöinen slaughters various animals, hoping to find them in their brain. His research proving fruitless, he resolves to visit the awful realm of Tuoni, whose daughter, on hearing his story, takes him in a boat across her father's river. The arrival of a living person in the regions of the dead is a marvellous event, and Wäinämöinen is hospitably entertained, and laid to rest in Tuoni's own bed. To prevent his return, three members of Tuoni's family make a large net, which is laid across the river; but the art of Wäinämöinen is superior to such an obstacle, and he slips through the meshes in the form of a worm.

The words, however, are still unknown, and Wäinämöinen is advised by an old shepherd to learn them from the mouth of a sage named Wipunen, to reach whom he must travel on the points of a needle and sword, and the edge of a battle-axe. Ilmarinen makes an iron suit to qualify him for this adventure; and though he finds Wipunen dead, with trees growing out of his remains, he removes these impediments, and wandering about the huge mouth of the corpse, slips down his throat. However, by making his iron raiment into an anvil, and doing smith's work upon it, he so grievously torments Wipunen, that, notwithstanding his defunct condition, he insists, with a torrent of imprecations, on his immediate departure. But Wäinämöinen will not go till the object of his journey is attained; and Wipunen at last sings a wondrous song about the origin of things, in which the desired words are contained. Furnished with these, Wäinämöinen leaves his singular place of sojourn, returns home, finishes his boat, and sets off for Pohjola to try his fortune with the celebrated maiden. As he passes along, he is seen by Ilmarinen's sister Annikki, who asks him whither he is going. He first endeavours to put her off with a series of falsehoods,—a very common practice with Finnish heroes,—but at last confesses the truth; upon which Annikki hastens to her brother, and demanding the manufacture of sundry trinkets as the price of her communication, tells him that Wäinämöinen is endeavouring to steal a march upon him. Accordingly Ilmarinen, thoroughly washing himself, and putting on his best clothes, sets off likewise for Pohjola in a magnificent sledge, and soon overtakes Wäinämöinen. The two old friends agree that they will not quarrel, nor endeavour to carry off the maiden by violence, but fairly leave her to the exercise of her own free will in the choice between them. When they both reach the place of their destination, they are kindly received, and Wäinämöinen, who shows how he has manufactured the required boat from the distaff, would be gladly accepted by Louhi as a son-in-law, while the daughter prefers the young-looking and handsome Ilmarinen.

The persevering smith now makes up his mind that he will not be deprived of his just reward, and tells Louhi that until the maiden is given to him he will not taste another drop of mead. The hostess of Pohjola begins to impose new conditions. In the first place, Ilmarinen must plough a field of snakes; and it is fortunate that he now has an auxiliary in t m that the feat may easily be